Syllabus Edition
First teaching 2025
First exams 2027

Not your syllabus?

Analysis of Market Research Data

Exam code: 0450, 0986 & 0264, 0774

Download PDF

Written by: Lisa Eades
Reviewed by: Steve Vorster
Updated on 27 August 2025

Quantitative and qualitative data

- Once market research data has been gathered, it need to be converted into a form which is **easy to understand** and capable of being used to **support business decision-making**
- **Quantitative data is statistical numeric data that can be used to support decision making**
  - Quantitative data needs to be **accurate** and **interpreted correctly** if it is to be useful
  - It may be collected from **primary** or **secondary** sources
  - **Sources** of quantitative data include
    - Financial reports
    - Survey findings
    - Marketing or sales data
    - Statistical research from the government or research organisations
- **Qualitative research data often requires considerable skill and insight to be interpreted appropriately**
  - It involves comparing and drawing conclusions from **opinions, insights, feelings and preferences**
  - It is **mainly collected from primary sources** such as focus groups, detailed surveys/interviews and test marketing
- Both forms of data **can help business managers forecast sales**, identify **trends** and **make decisions** about product development, promotional planning, pricing tactics and other important **marketing mix** elements

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

charts

- Information presented in **graphs and charts** is often **easy to understand** because it is presented **visually**
- Common methods of presenting data include:
  - Tally charts
  - Bar charts
  - Pie graphs
  - Scatter graphs

Tally charts

- **A table** or **tally chart,** is a simple method used to **record data in its original form**
  - It is particularly useful for recording **frequency** of an event **as it is happening**
    - E.g., It may be used to record the number of customers entering a retail store
  - Each time a particular event happens, a small vertical line is drawn
    - **Groups of five** occurrences are recorded with a **diagonal line through four vertical lines**
    - These groups of five can be easily **totalled to identify frequency**
- In many cases, tally chart data is **converted into a chart or graph** to make it more **visually appealing**

Worked Example

Susie asks her friends to select their favourite type of pet.

Dog	Cat	Dog	Dog	Dog
Rabbit	Dog	Rabbit	Cat	Cat
Cat	Dog	Dog	Rabbit	Dog
Cat	Cat	Dog	Dog	Dog

Represent the data in a frequency table. You can use a tally chart to help

Step 1: **Draw a table with a tally and frequency column with types of pet as row headers**

Type of pet	Tally	Frequency
Dog		
Cat		
Rabbit		

Step 2: Tally the data

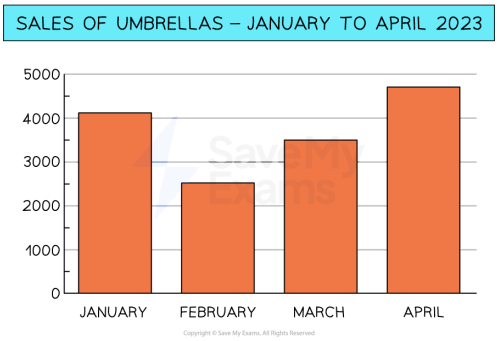
Dog	卌 卌	
Cat	卌 I	
Rabbit	III	

Step 3: Total the tally data and add to the frequency column

Type of pet	Tally	Frequency
Dog	卌 卌 I	11
Cat	卌 I	6
Rabbit	III	3

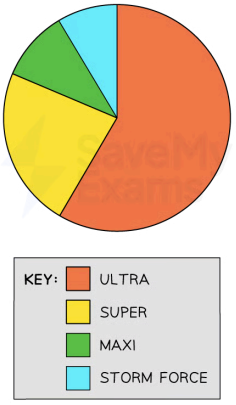
Bar charts

- This bar graph provides a clear picture of umbrella sales between January and April and allows a manager **to compare sales** month by month



Pie charts

- This pie chart breaks down all umbrella sales into those **achieved by different models**
- It **shows** that more than half of sales were 'Ultra' umbrellas



Pie chart showing the sales of umbrellas over four months

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Practise calculations such as **percentages and averages** – errors in simple maths can cost easy marks, so always double-check your working and units

Scatter graphs

- Scatter graphs allow **relationships between two variables** to be identified
- The scatter graph below shows that there is a **positive correlation** between temperature and sales of barbecues
  - As the temperature increases, sales of barbecues increase

A scatter graph showing the correlation between the temperature and the sale of umbrellas

- A **line of best fit** allows known data to be **extrapolated** to identify likely sales of barbecues at other temperatures

Scatter graph showing a line of best fit

Teacher only

New! Exclusive Teacher-Only Questions

- Fresh, expert-written questions
- Students can't access them
- Fair accurate tests - built fast

Explore in Test Builder

Test yourself

Flashcards

Was this revision note helpful? Yes No

Previous

Next

Course

Study tools

All topics

Resources

Learning Hub

Scholarship

Join

Past Papers

Solution Banks

Dashboard

Overview

Brand ambassador

Profile

Subscription

Settings

About us
Exam Specificity
Content Quality
Promotions
Jobs
Terms
Privacy
Cookie Policy
Help and Support

Biology
Chemistry
Physics
Maths
Geography
English Literature
Psychology
All Subjects

© Copyright 2015–2026 Save My Exams Ltd. All Rights Reserved.
Neither IBO nor College Board were involved in the production of, and do not endorse, the resources created by Save My Exams.